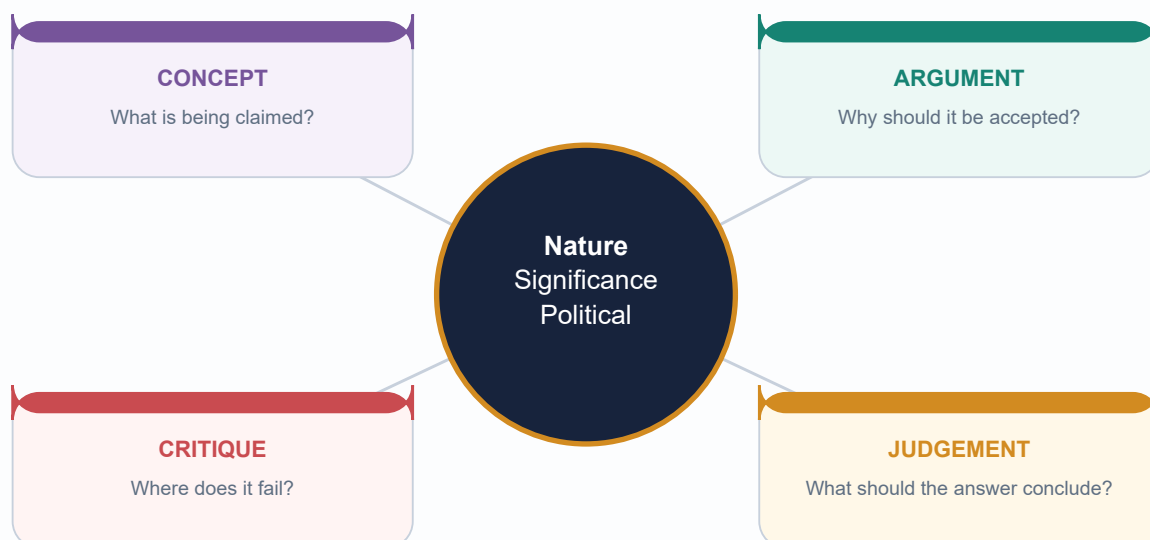


UPSC POLITICAL THEORY WORKBOOK

Nature and Significance of Political Theory Solved-Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory | Paper: GS-II / Political Theory
Eight source-trap MCQs with strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation
Original 10-, 15- and 20-mark solved content frameworks



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Topic-Specific MCQ Loop 1

GS-II / Political
Theory Political
Theory

INTRO & ORIGIN

Each question is generated from an explicit source-chapter trap and explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Q1. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Political theory is merely normative."?
- A. ☐ Gauba explicitly includes political science as a part of theory, so theory includes factual explanation as well as value-judgment (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).
- B. Political theory is merely normative.
- C. Political theory is identical with ideology.
- D. Political philosophy only designs ideal states.
- ANSWER: A - ☐ Gauba explicitly includes political science as a part of theory, so theory includes factual explanation as well as value-judgment (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).
- Q2. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Political theory is identical with ideology."?
- A. Political theory is identical with ideology.
- B. ☐ Theory critically examines claims; ideology justifies or denounces a power arrangement from an interested standpoint (Gauba, PDF p.20).
- C. Political philosophy only designs ideal states.
- D. Behaviouralism made political theory unnecessary.
- ANSWER: B - ☐ Theory critically examines claims; ideology justifies or denounces a power arrangement from an interested standpoint (Gauba, PDF p.20).
- Q3. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Political philosophy only designs ideal states."?
- A. Political philosophy only designs ideal states.
- B. Behaviouralism made political theory unnecessary.
- C. ☐ Raphael's role, adopted here, is criticism, justification and concept-clarification, not fantasy alone (Gauba, PDF pp.19-20).
- D. Evaluative statements are automatically irrational.
- ANSWER: C - ☐ Raphael's role, adopted here, is criticism, justification and concept-clarification, not fantasy alone (Gauba, PDF pp.19-20).
- Q4. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Behaviouralism made political theory unnecessary."?
- A. Behaviouralism made political theory unnecessary.
- B. Evaluative statements are automatically irrational.
- C. Do not shift into constitutional Articles or institutional detail here.
- D. ☐ Even Gauba's summary of post-behaviouralism restores values while preserving scientific method for facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23).
- ANSWER: D - ☐ Even Gauba's summary of post-behaviouralism restores values while preserving scientific method for facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23).

MEMORY HOOK

Resolve the misconception before memorising the fact.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Nature and Significance of Political Theory ->
Source-grounded practice

HIGH**Topic-Specific MCQ Loop 2****GS-II / Political
Theory** Political
Theory**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Each question is generated from an explicit source-chapter trap and explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Q5. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Evaluative statements are automatically irrational."?

- A. ☐ Gauba rejects that dismissal and argues that values can be debated through dialogue and reasoning (Gauba, PDF pp.16-17, 20).

- B. Evaluative statements are automatically irrational.

- C. Do not shift into constitutional Articles or institutional detail here.

- D. Do not turn this file into a separate methods manual or a list of constitutional institutions.

- ANSWER: A - ☐ Gauba rejects that dismissal and argues that values can be debated through dialogue and reasoning (Gauba, PDF pp.16-17, 20).

- Q6. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Do not shift into constitutional Articles or institutional detail here."?

- A. Do not shift into constitutional Articles or institutional detail here.

- B. ☐ Those belong to Polity/basic/Fundamental-Rights.md, Polity/basic/Parliament.md, Polity/advanced/07_Fundamental-Rights.md and Polity/advanced/17_Parliament.md.

- C. Do not turn this file into a separate methods manual or a list of constitutional institutions.

- D. Post-behaviouralism rejects science.

- ANSWER: B - ☐ Those belong to Polity/basic/Fundamental-Rights.md, Polity/basic/Parliament.md, Polity/advanced/07_Fundamental-Rights.md and Polity/advanced/17_Parliament.md.

- Q7. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Do not turn this file into a separate methods manual or a list of constitutional institutions."?

- A. Do not turn this file into a separate methods manual or a list of constitutional institutions.

- B. Post-behaviouralism rejects science.

- C. ☐ Keep it on the conceptual dispute over what counts as valid political knowledge.

- D. Political theory is merely normative.

- ANSWER: C - ☐ Keep it on the conceptual dispute over what counts as valid political knowledge.

- Q8. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "Post-behaviouralism rejects science."?

- A. Post-behaviouralism rejects science.

- B. Political theory is merely normative.

- C. Political theory is identical with ideology.

- D. ☐ Gauba says it revives values without compromising scientific method for the study of facts (Gauba, PDF p.19).

- ANSWER: D - ☐ Gauba says it revives values without compromising scientific method for the study of facts (Gauba, PDF p.19).

MEMORY HOOK

Resolve the misconception before memorising the fact.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Nature and Significance of Political Theory ->
Source-grounded practice

HIGH**Solved 10-Mark Practice**

**GS-II / Political
Theory** Political
Theory

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain Nature and Significance of Political Theory with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE**1. Concept**

Define the exact scope and terminology.

V

2. Core analysis

Organise the source content into two or three dimensions.

V

3. Evidence

Use the chapter's India-centric examples or chronology.

V

4. Critical layer

Add traps, limitations, counter-view or implementation constraints.

V

5. Judgement

Conclude in direct response to the directive.

STATIC THEORY

- □ This chapter gives the module's basic vocabulary: what counts as political, what a theory is, and why political theory includes both factual explanation and value-judgment (Gaubu, PDF pp.15-18).
- □ Gauba treats political science and political philosophy as complementary, not rival, components of political theory; this is the base for later files on ideology, approaches, power, rights and democracy (Gaubu, PDF pp.17-18, 23, 27).
- □□ In UPSC and PSIR answers, this topic prevents two common errors: reducing theory to moral sermon, or reducing it to data without a judgment on ends.
- □□ This file is foundational for questions on methods, values, legitimacy, liberty, equality, justice and public policy because all of them require a facts-plus-values frame.
- □ A question such as "why do riots occur?" belongs to political science when it seeks causal explanation through observation and generalization (Gaubu, PDF pp.18-19, 21).
- □ A question such as "what is a good society?" belongs to political philosophy because it asks about ends, justification and value (Gaubu, PDF p.17).
- □ Clarifying whether "freedom" means non-interference, self-development or something else is part of political philosophy's concept-clarifying role (Gaubu, PDF pp.19, 22).
- □ Gauba warns that vague political language allows demagogues and autocrats to exploit words like liberty, equality and democracy for emotional manipulation or legitimation (Gaubu, PDF p.22).
- □□ A strong answer can therefore use data to explain unemployment, but it still needs a philosophical yardstick to judge whether a given policy is fair, free or humane.
- □ For the full decline/revival debate, move to [Political-Theory/advanced/01_Nature-and-Significance-of-Political-Theory.md](#).
- □ For methods, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism in a dedicated file, use [Political-Theory/basic/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md](#) and [Political-Theory/advanced/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md](#).
- □ For authority and power terms introduced here, later connect with [Political-Theory/basic/15_Power-Authority-and-Legitimacy.md](#).
- □ For thinker-specific optional depth on ideologies and state-individual relations, link outward rather than duplicating: [Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Political-Ideologies.md](#) and [Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Individual-and-State.md](#).
- □ Political means the public/common sphere of authoritative collective regulation (Gaubu, PDF pp.15-16).
- □ Political theory means systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gaubu, PDF p.16).

MAINS ANGLE

These are model content points; arrange them into paragraphs rather than reproducing a list.

STUDY LINK

Nature and Significance of Political Theory -> 10-mark answer

HIGH

Solved 15-Mark Practice

GS-II / Political
Theory Political
Theory

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analyse Nature and Significance of Political Theory with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

1. Concept

Define the exact scope and terminology.

V

2. Core analysis

Organise the source content into two or three dimensions.

V

3. Evidence

Use the chapter's India-centric examples or chronology.

V

4. Critical layer

Add traps, limitations, counter-view or implementation constraints.

V

5. Judgement

Conclude in direct response to the directive.

STATIC THEORY

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- □ Clarifying whether "freedom" means non-interference, self-development or something else is part of political philosophy's concept-clarifying role (Gaubu, PDF pp.19, 22).
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- □ Political theory means systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gaubu, PDF p.16).

MAINS ANGLE

These are model content points; arrange them into paragraphs rather than reproducing a list.

STUDY LINK

[Nature and Significance of Political Theory -> 15-mark answer](#)

HIGH

Solved 20-Mark PracticeGS-II / Political
Theory Political
Theory**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Critically examine Nature and Significance of Political Theory with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE**1. Concept**

Define the exact scope and terminology.

V

2. Core analysis

Organise the source content into two or three dimensions.

V

3. Evidence

Use the chapter's India-centric examples or chronology.

V

4. Critical layer

Add traps, limitations, counter-view or implementation constraints.

V

5. Judgement

Conclude in direct response to the directive.

STATIC THEORY

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- □ A question such as "what is a good society?" belongs to political philosophy because it asks about ends, justification and value (Gaubu, PDF p.17).
- □ Clarifying whether "freedom" means non-interference, self-development or something else is part of political philosophy's concept-clarifying role (Gaubu, PDF pp.19, 22).
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MAINS ANGLE

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STUDY LINK

Nature and Significance of Political Theory -> 20-mark answer

HIGH

Workbook Rapid Revision

GS-II / Political
Theory Political
Theory

INTRO & ORIGIN

Final revision is placed after teaching and solved practice.

TOPIC RECALL MAP

Nature and Significance of Political Theory

V

Definition □ This chapter gives the module's basic vocabulary: what counts as political, what a theory is, and why political theory includes both factual explanation and value-judgment (Gauba, PDF pp.15-18).	Mechanism □ Gauba treats political science and political philosophy as complementary, not rival, components of political theory; this is the base for later files on ideology, approaches, power, rights and democracy (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18, 23, 27).
Application □□ In UPSC and PSIR answers, this topic prevents two common errors: reducing theory to moral sermon, or reducing it to data without a judgment on ends.	Evaluation □□ This file is foundational for questions on methods, values, legitimacy, liberty, equality, justice and public policy because all of them require a facts-plus-values frame.

STATIC THEORY

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MEMORY HOOK

Meaning -> mechanism -> evidence -> limitation -> judgement

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. □ For thinker-specific optional depth on ideologies and state-individual relations, link outward rather than duplicating: Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Political-Ideologies.md and Philosophy/paper-2/socio-political/Individual-and-State.md.
2. □ Political means the public/common sphere of authoritative collective regulation (Gauba, PDF pp.15-16).
3. □ Political theory means systematic knowledge of political phenomena (Gauba, PDF p.16).
4. □ The chapter's three statement-types are empirical, logical and evaluative (Gauba, PDF p.16).
5. □ Political science relies on observation, generalization and explanation; political philosophy seeks justification and concept-clarification (Gauba, PDF pp.18-20).
6. □ Theory must include both science and philosophy because public policy needs facts and values together (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Political theory is merely normative.

CORRECT: □ Gauba explicitly includes political science as a part of theory, so theory includes factual explanation as well as value-judgment (Gauba, PDF pp.17-18).

WRONG: Political theory is identical with ideology.

CORRECT: □ Theory critically examines claims; ideology justifies or denounces a power arrangement from an interested standpoint (Gauba, PDF p.20).

WRONG: Political philosophy only designs ideal states.

CORRECT: □ Raphael's role, adopted here, is criticism, justification and concept-clarification, not fantasy alone (Gauba, PDF pp.19-20).

WRONG: Behaviouralism made political theory unnecessary.

CORRECT: □ Even Gauba's summary of post-behaviouralism restores values while preserving scientific method for facts (Gauba, PDF pp.18-19, 23).

MAINS ANGLE

Use Nature and Significance of Political Theory as an argument, not as an unstructured list of facts.

STUDY LINK

Political Theory -> Nature and Significance of Political Theory

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI